

Activity 1 - Screen and Select the HarbourHub Pilot

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 1 | Initiation of a Project
Learning outcome: LO1 Duration: 35 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Small Project Screening, Multi-Criteria Selection and Cost-Benefit Analysis

Objective

Confirm that the proposed work is a viable small project and recommend the best option (A1, K1).

The situation

HarbourHub Fresh has three competing improvement ideas: click-and-collect, a loyalty app, and a warehouse automation study. Only one can be funded this quarter. The sponsor needs a transparent selection decision and evidence that the selected work fits the small-project profile.

What you will do

Apply the small-project screen, compare options using weighted criteria, test the financial case and document the recommendation, assumptions and rejection reasons.

What you will produce

A completed small-project screen, weighted option scorecard, cost-benefit check and sponsor-ready selection recommendation.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/02 Cost Benefit Analysis.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/01 Small Project Screening and Selection.xlsx`](#)

Data files

- [`data/option-briefs.csv`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Read the three option briefs and separate desired outcomes from proposed solutions.
2. Apply the small-project screen: temporary, unique, under six months, limited budget/team and limited interdependencies.
3. Agree five weighted decision criteria covering value, feasibility, urgency, risk and strategic fit.
4. Score each option using evidence; record the rationale beside every score.
5. Open the cost-benefit template and test the preferred option using the S\$180,000 ceiling and a 20% downside case.
6. Record assumptions, exclusions and one non-financial factor that the arithmetic does not capture.
7. Recommend approve for chartering, hold for more evidence, or reject; state the sponsor decision required.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

The selected option satisfies every small-project criterion, the weighted score reconciles, the financial downside is visible and the recommendation states a clear gate decision.

Debrief

- Selection prevents the team from efficiently delivering the wrong project.
- Weights expose priorities; narrative rationale prevents false precision.
- A selected idea is still not authorised work until the charter gate is passed.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 1. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.